

THE OFFICIAL PUBLICATION OF THE SAN ANTONIO PHILATELIC ASSOCIATION FOUNDED 1896



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TPA Life Chapter #3

Upcoming Meeting Calendar – 2026

Visitors Are Always Welcome!

	October 2026		November 2026		December 2026
2	Board Of Governors Meeting Program: “Show and Tell”	6	Board Of Governors Meeting Program: “Show and Tell”	4	Board Of Governors Meeting Program: “Show and Tell” Blue-Chip Auction Lot Viewing
9	Stamp Program: “Expertising Philatelics” by Jimmy Tomchesson Visitors Welcome	13	Club Auction – Visitors Welcome	11	SAPA Blue-Chip Auction
16	Club Auction – Visitors Welcome	20	Stamp Bourse – Visitors Welcome Blue-Chip Auction Lot Viewing Blue-Chip Auction Lot Verification	18	Club Holiday Party – 6:00 pm
23	Stamp Bourse – buy, sell, & trade Visitors Welcome	27	NO MEETING – Thanksgiving Holiday	25	NO MEETING – Christmas Holiday
30	NO MEETING – Halloween Holiday				

All meetings are held at the **MacArthur Park Lutheran Church**, 2903 Nacogdoches Road, San Antonio, TX, 78217 in Building 1, which faces Nacogdoches Rd. Doors open at 6:30 PM, BOG meetings begin at 7:15 and all other meetings begin at 7:30.

WE WELCOME VISITORS

In Fond Memory of Steve Mabie



Steve Mabie passed away peacefully on July 1, 2026 after a brave battle with cancer. Steve was born in Philadelphia and served his country in the U.S. Air Force. Steve joined SAPA in 2014 and served as SAPA treasurer from 2024 until 2026 and newsletter editor from 2024 until 2025. As treasurer, he helped with the monthly auctions as the cashier, a challenging task. Steve also completed the annual club income tax returns and coordinated the financial audits. Steve was an avid stamp collector and a friend to all SAPA members. He is survived by his wife, Nancy Mabie, who is also a SAPA member, five children, and his seven cherished grandchildren. Steve will be greatly missed and remembered for his commitment to his family, his lifelong passion for stamp collecting, and his unforgettable sense of humor. His family suggests memorial contributions be made to the San Antonio Philatelic Association (13530 FM 1560N, Helotes, TX 78023).

October 9 Stamp Program

At the SAPA meeting on October 9, after the first day of the San Antonio TSDA Stamp Show, Jimmy Tomchesson from Philatelic Stamp Authentication and Grading (PSAG), a firm specializing in expertising and grading stamps, will be giving a presentation about his specialty. The title of his presentation is "Expertising Philatelics." He will provide information on how stamps are expertised, which stamps should be expertised, and why. Be sure to attend this interesting and relevant presentation.

Mark your calendars for the San Antonio Stamp Show!

The San Antonio Texas Stamp Dealers Association Show will be held on October 9 and 10 at the Norris Conference Center, 618 Northwest Freeway Loop 410 (across San Pedro from the North Star Mall). Hours for the show are Friday 10 – 5 and Saturday 9 – 4. The SA Stamp Show is held semi-annually and is a great opportunity for experienced philatelists to add some elusive issues to their collection. It's also a great experience for newer collectors to add to their collection, fill some holes in their albums, and

learn more about the hobby from experienced experts. And the dealers would love to meet newer members.

It's important that SAPA members support this show, not necessarily by purchasing stamps and supplies at the show, but also by showing up and talking to the dealers. A busy dealer is a happy dealer! The number of dealers has declined in recent years, although the quality of the dealers remains at a very high level. The last two shows have shown a dramatic upturn in the number of people who have attended the show and if word gets around that people will attend the show, more dealers may be willing to make the trip from Houston and Dallas/Fort Worth to the San Antonio show. I encourage all SAPA members to attend the show and support stamp collecting in San Antonio!

SAPA Annual Blue-Chip Auction

Each year in December SAPA holds a Blue-Chip Auction, and this year is no exception. The Blue-Chip Auction differs from club auctions in several ways. First, Blue-Chip lots must have a catalog value of at least \$20, although the opening bid on the lot may be lower than \$20. Each lot containing stamps must include the Scott (or other recognized Company) Catalog number, the catalog value, and the year of the catalog used to determine the value. There are several sources available during club meetings to obtain this information. The condition of the stamp(s) must also be described (hinged, used, never hinged, regummed, etc).

All lots submitted before November 20 will be reviewed by a panel of experts who will verify the lot description and the catalog value. A list of the lots will be sent to all SAPA members and several dealers before the auction night, and the lots will be on display at the meetings on November 20 and December 4. Lots may be submitted after November 20, including on the day of the auction, but these lots will not be verified by SAPA experts.

Something Punny

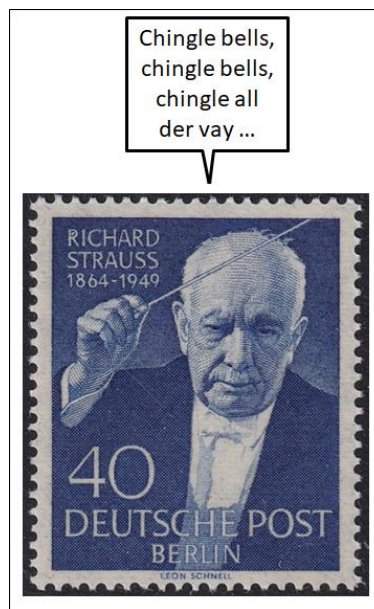
A man recently had a severely negative reaction after licking a postage stamp. Doctors decided it was anaphilatelic shock.

SAPA Holiday Party

The annual SAPA Holiday Party will be held on December 18 at 6:00 in the meeting room. SAPA will provide barbecue (brisket and turkey). Please bring a side dish or a dessert to share if you are able. But please come – although we only had about 12 people at the summer picnic, we all had a good time along with the great food.

Talking Stamps

Stamp humor inspired by the Holiday Season and Mad Magazine's "Talking Stamps," written and published by Frank Jacobs.



What is a Bourse?

If you look at the SAPA calendar, you will notice that we have at least one "bourse" scheduled each month, and sometimes two. In English, the word bourse refers to a marketplace where securities, commodities, or currencies are bought and sold. Bourse can take on a different meaning depending on the context. In specialized trades such as stamp collecting, a bourse is a dedicated event or room where dealers and collectors gather to buy, sell, and trade. At SAPA, we've extended the definition to mean a night of stamp trading, sales, and lots of stamp talk! Bring items to sell, trade, or give away! Anyone interested in stamps is welcome to attend a SAPA bourse. It's a fun social evening of buying, selling, trading, and talking stamps!

Featured Article: Postal Note Stamps!

Postal Note Stamps were introduced on February 1, 1945, for sending small amounts of money to another person (up to \$10) at a lower cost than money orders. The stamps were only used at specific post offices and required less paperwork for the postal clerk. Postal Note Stamps were affixed to Postal Notes, which consisted of the payee's coupon, the paying office coupon, and the purchaser's receipt. The stamps were affixed to the paying office coupon, which was kept by the post office as proof that the money had been paid. The stamps were issued in 18 denominations for the 11 denominations of notes, with up to two stamps affixed per note, plus optional insurance for 5¢. Postal Note stamps were discontinued on March 31, 1951, after six years of use. These stamps are an affordable and interesting addition to the US collector's Back of Book Section with the catalog prefix "PN."



See the full story [here](http://info.mysticstamp.com/this-day-in-history-march-31-1951_tdi/), including beautiful high-definition, full-color images (info.mysticstamp.com/this-day-in-history-march-31-1951_tdi/).

Error in Stamp Design

Here is an item provided by SAPA member Howard Wallace depicting an error in the stamp design. Can you spot the error?



For the answer, see the last page of this newsletter.

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Write to SAPA

San Antonio Philatelic Association
c/o Al Lozano
13530 FM 1560N
Helotes, TX 78023

Upcoming TSDA Shows

Hours for all TSDA shows are Friday 10 – 5 and Saturday 9 – 4

November 13-14 **MID-CITIES STAMP CLUB EXPO**, Grapevine Convention Center, 1209 Main St., Grapevine, TX 76051. Highway 114 at Main Street exit, just north of DFW Airport.

December 11-12 **DALLAS TSDA**, Holiday Inn & Suites – 3220 Craig Drive, McKinney, TX 75070.

January 8-9, 2027 **HOUSTON TSDA**, Hilton Garden Inn – Energy Corridor, 12245 Katy Freeway (I-10 and Dairy Ashford Exit), Houston, TX 77079.

The San Antonio and South Texas Postcard Club meets on the third Monday of each month at 6:00 at the Granados Adult and Senior Center, 500 West Freiling, San Antonio. Gathering begins at 6:00 and the meeting starts at 6:30.

Coming Soon!

Beginning in January 2027, **The Philatex** will (hopefully) return to a bimonthly schedule. If you would like to submit an article or would like to see an article written about a philatelic topic, please submit your ideas / articles to Jim Durham at any meeting or email me at jsdurham4@gmail.com. I am always looking for interesting and relevant topics for the newsletter.

Error in Stamp Design answer: Columbus is shown looking for land in 1492 with a telescope, which wasn't invented until the 17th century. This depiction of Columbus with a telescope is repeated on multiple issues from St. Kitts – Nevis.